

Global CO₂ Emissions

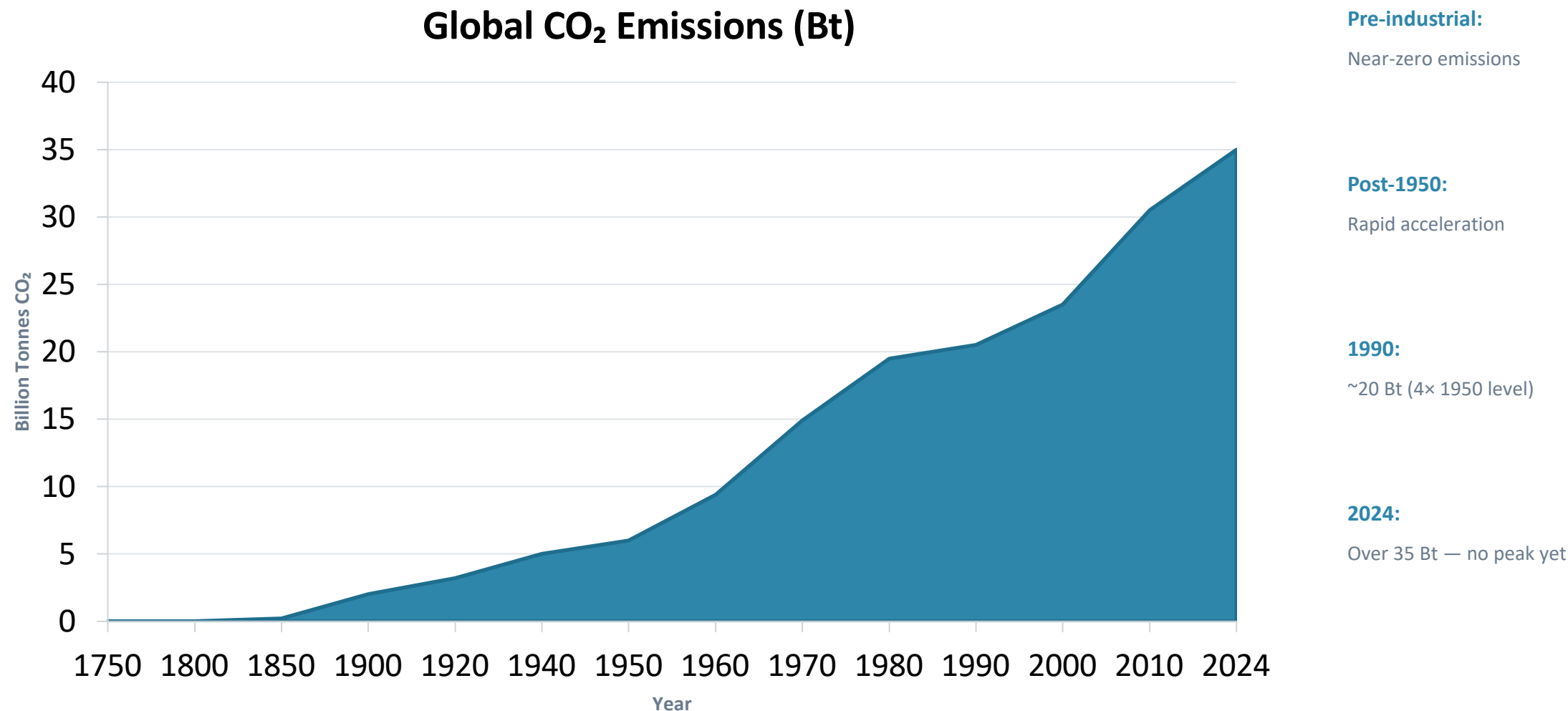
Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil Fuels & Industry · 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

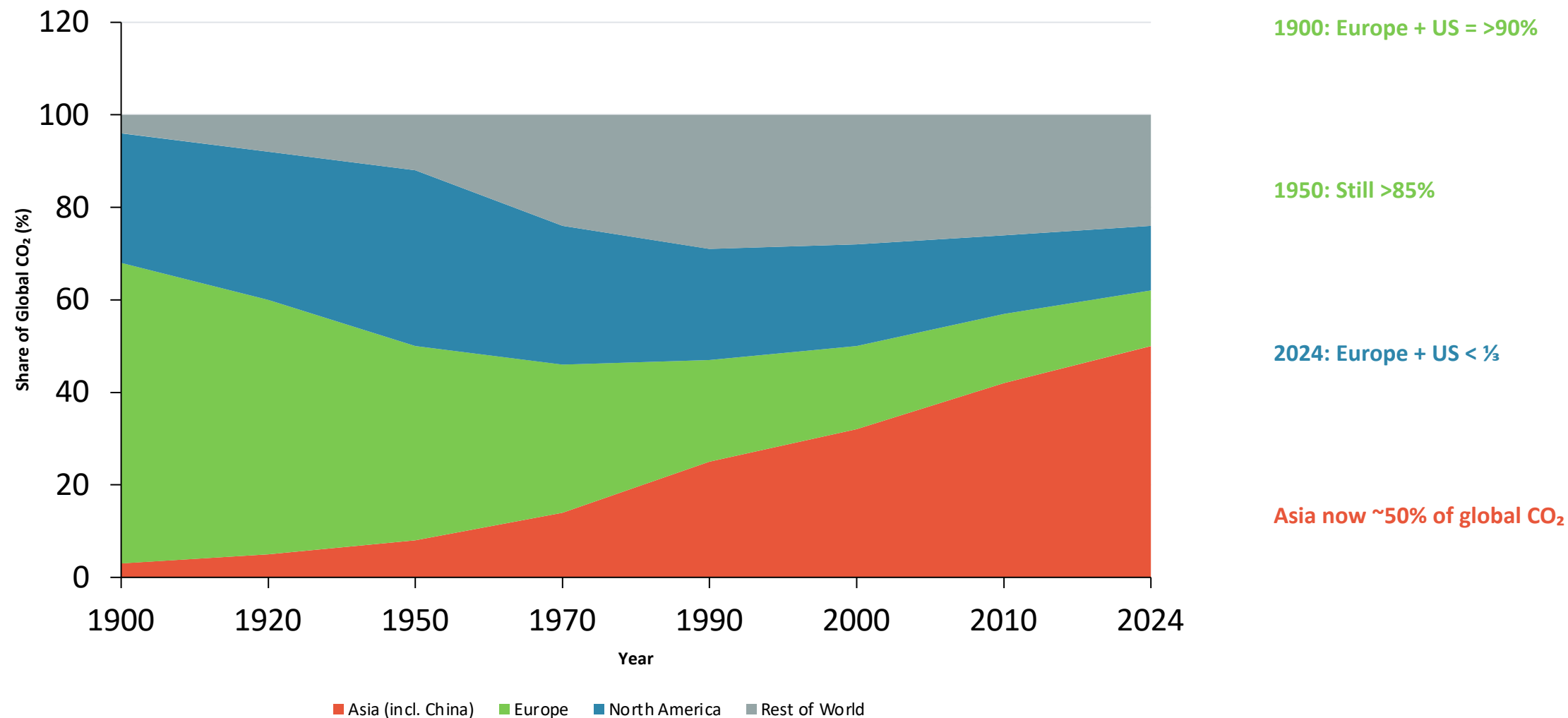
For policy analysts, climate negotiators, and sustainability researchers

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



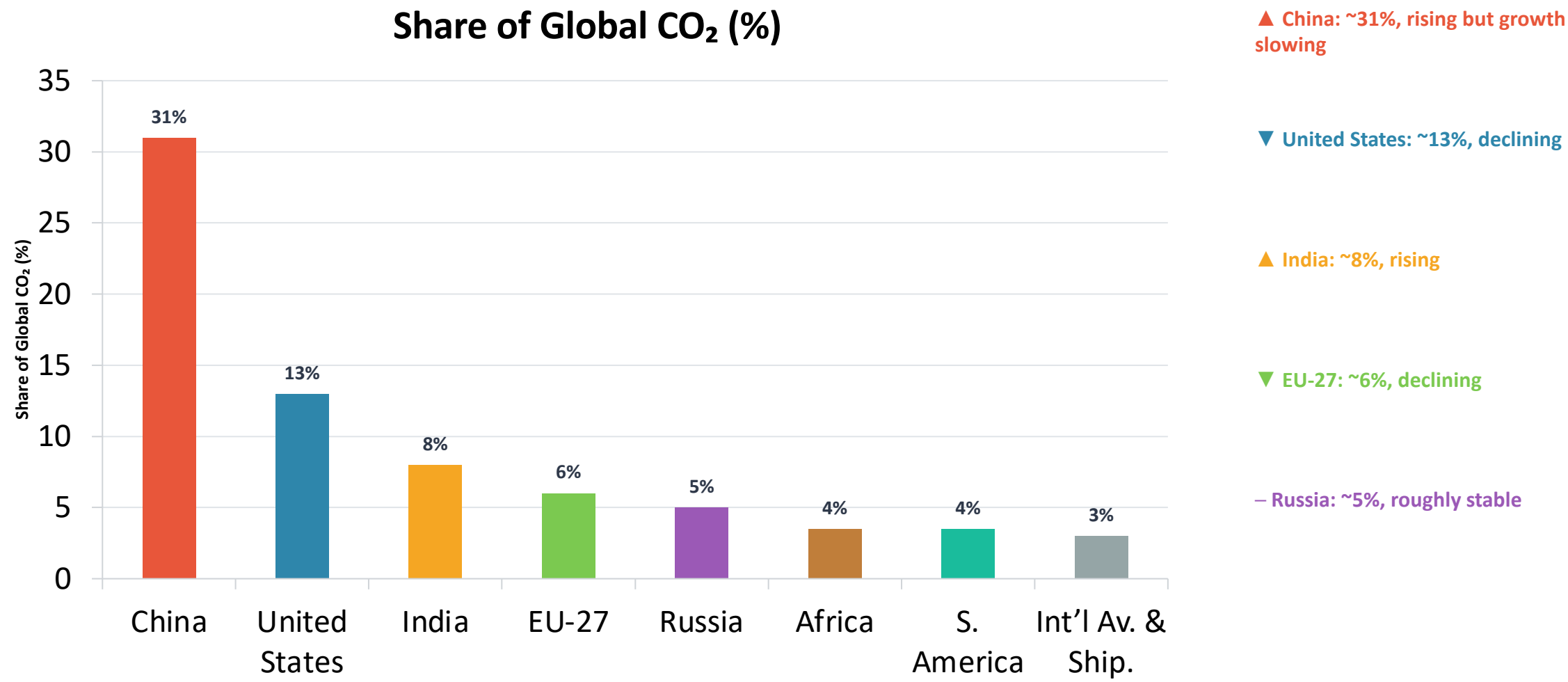
Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today

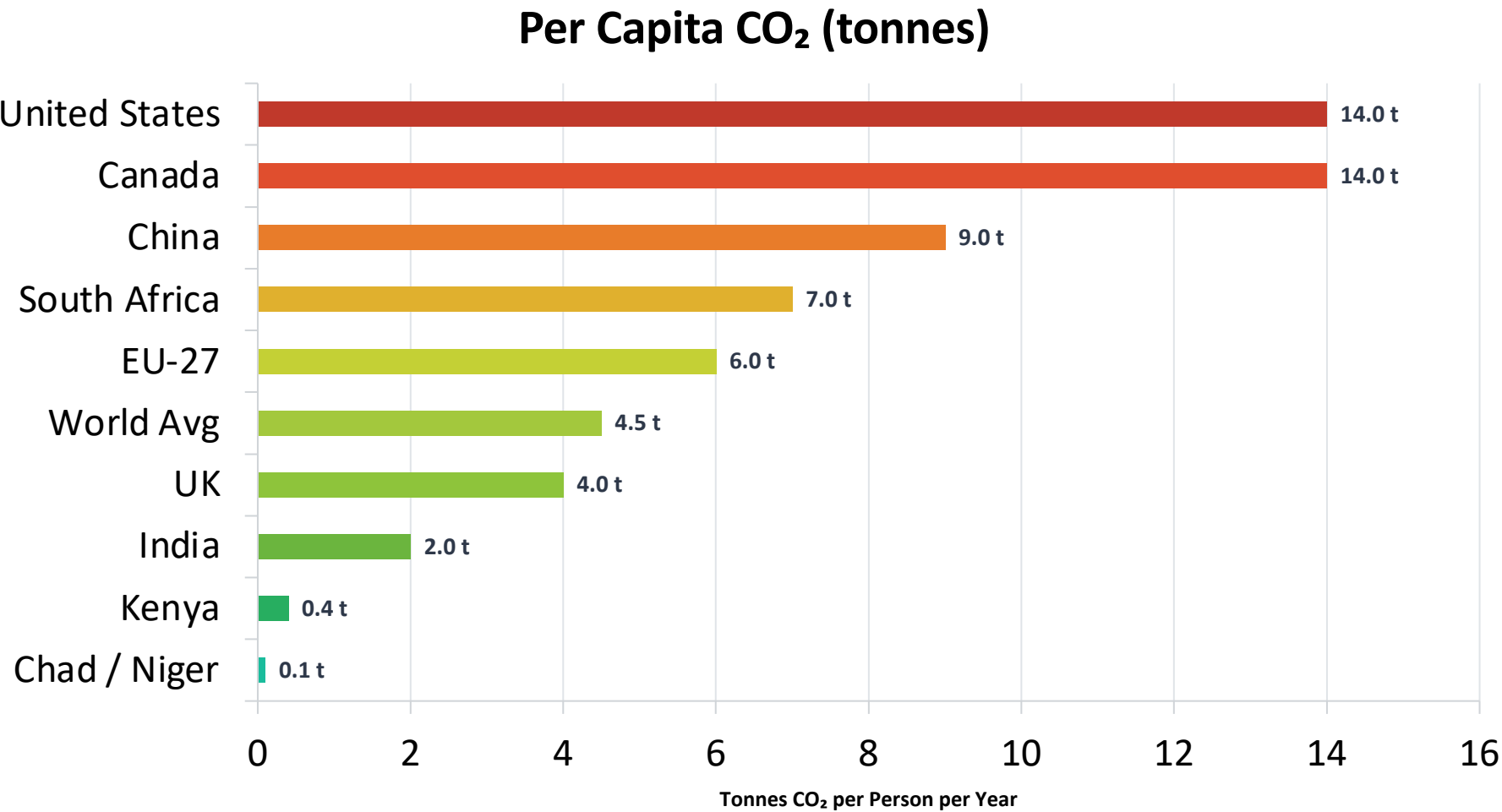


Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂



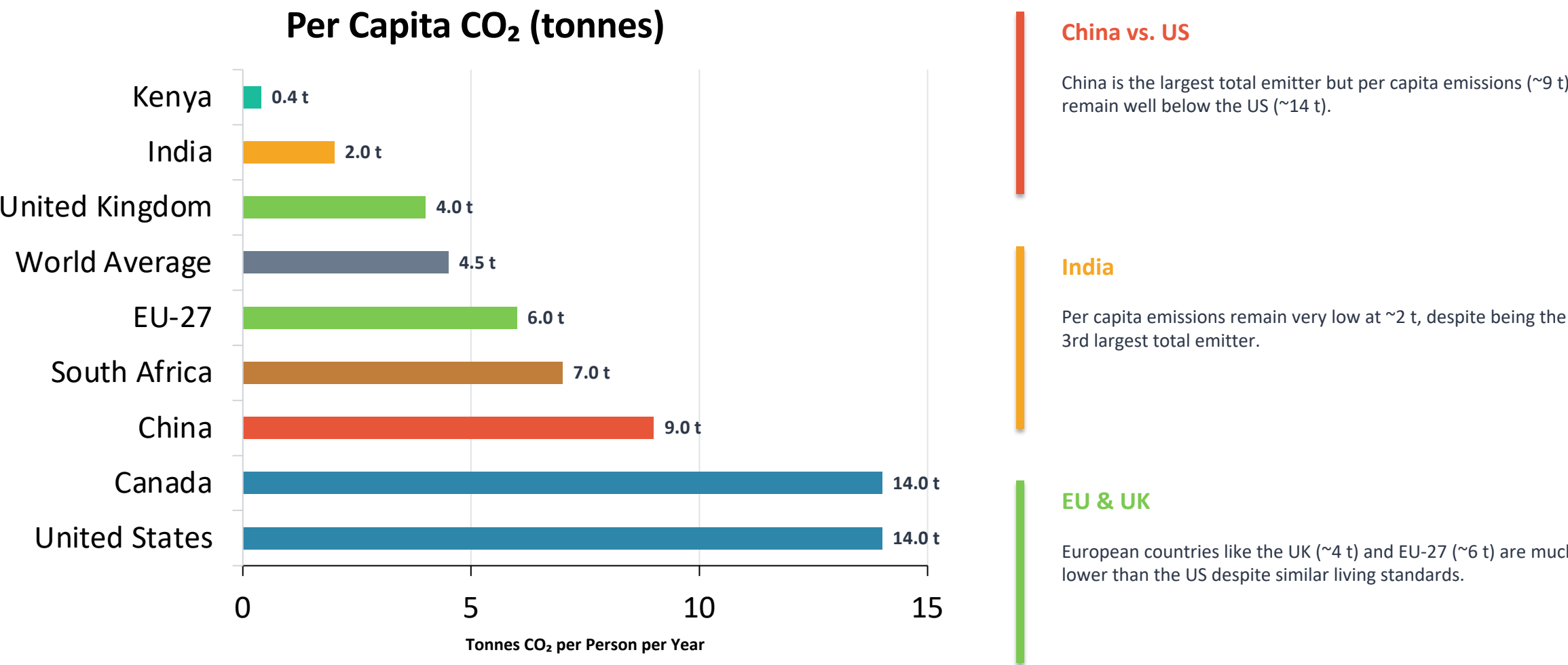
Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



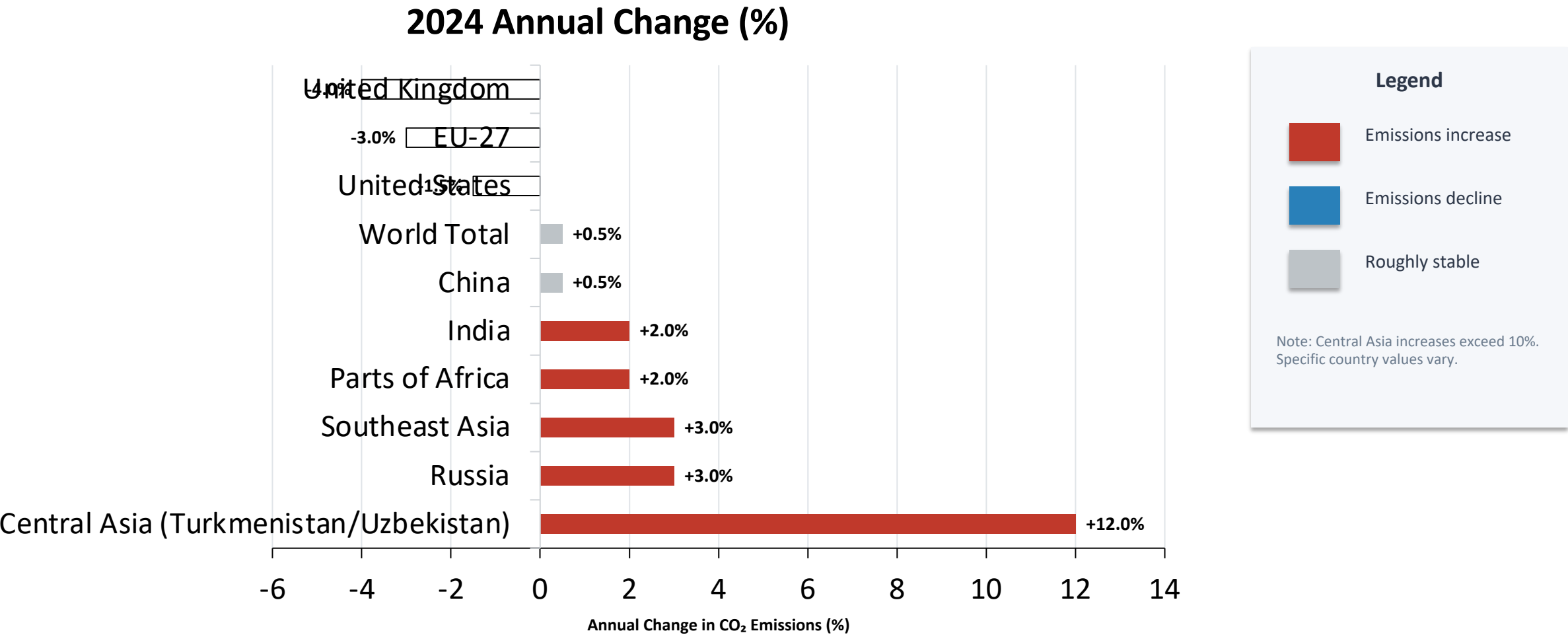
150× Gap

The average American emits in under 2 days what a person in Chad or Niger emits in an entire year.

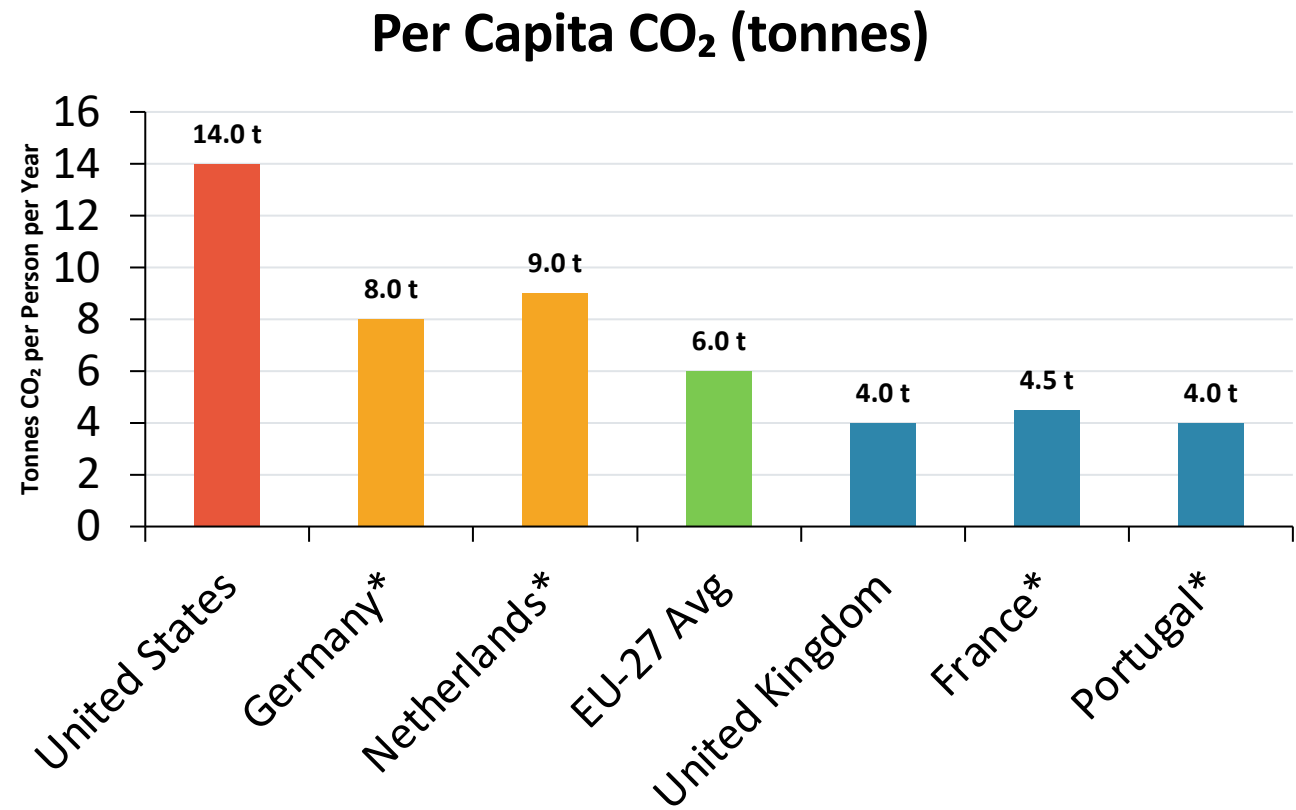
Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew



Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US



*Estimated from EU average and qualitative source data. Exact values not in source.

Key Insight

Among wealthy nations with similar prosperity levels, per capita emissions vary significantly because of energy mix choices.

Lower Per Capita Emitters

France, the UK, and Portugal have much lower per capita emissions because a higher share of their electricity comes from nuclear and renewable sources rather than fossil fuels.

Higher Per Capita Emitters

Germany, the Netherlands, and the US rely more heavily on coal and natural gas.

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

1

No Peak Yet

Global emissions exceed 35 Bt/year and have not yet peaked, despite slowing growth.

2

China Is Largest Annual Emitter

China emits ~31% of global CO₂, but per capita (~9 t) remains below the US (~14 t).

3

Historical Responsibility

Europe and the US dominated emissions historically (>90% in 1900) but now account for less than one-third.

4

150× Per Capita Gap

A 150× gap persists between the lowest emitters (Sub-Saharan Africa, ~0.1 t/person) and the highest (US/Canada/Australia, ~14–15 t/person).

5

Energy Policy Can Decouple

Countries with similar prosperity can have very different per capita emissions depending on energy mix — nuclear and renewables lower emissions without sacrificing living standards.